Active and Safe Route to School Study
Consent Form

Introduction: You are invited to take part in a study being conducted by researchers at Texas A&M Transportation Institute (TTI), funded by the Center for Efficient Mobility, a US Department of Transportation University Transportation Center.

Study purpose: The purpose of this study is to investigate mobility efficiency and the impact of different school commute modes—such as walking, bicycling, riding the bus, or being driven—on student mobility options, health, safety, and wellbeing. We aim to understand how factors like travel time, route reliability, and convenience influence your family's transportation choices. Your participation will help us identify barriers to efficient and active travel, guiding school districts and transportation agencies in designing optimized, safer, and healthier routes to school for all Texas students.

Eligibility criteria: You are eligible to participate if you are a parent or guardian of a school-aged child and are the person most involved in getting the child to and from school. If your family has multiple children attending school, please complete one survey for each child.

What you will be asked to do: You will be asked to complete a survey that takes approximately 10 minutes.

Risks and Incentives: These activities will not expose you to any more risk than what you would come across in everyday life.

Confidentiality: The records of this study will be kept private. No identifiers linking you to this study will be included in any sort of report that might be published. Research records will be stored securely and only the research personnel will have access to the records.

If you change your mind about participating: This research is completely voluntary. You may decide to not begin or to stop participating at any time.

Contact for more information: You may contact our study Coordinator, Minjie Xu, at M-Xu@tti.tamu.edu.

IRB NUMBER:

IRB APPROVAL DATE:

☐ **I agree to participate in the survey.**

Today's Date: __ __ / __ __ / __ __ __ __

(Month) (Day) (Year)

Directions: This survey is to be completed by the parent or guardian who is most involved in getting the child to and from school. If your family has multiple children attending school, please complete one survey for each child. All information provided will be kept strictly confidential.

Section 1: Travel to and from School

The first few questions are about how your child normally gets to and from school. Please answer the questions in both columns by checking the box that applies.

	From home to school	From school to home
1. On a normal day, how does your child travel?	☐ Walk *alone* ☐ Walk *with minor sibling(s)* ☐ Walk *with friend(s)* ☐ Walk *with a parent/adult* ☐ Bike ☐ Scooter ☐ School bus ☐ Public bus ☐ Private car ☐ Carpool	☐ Walk *alone* ☐ Walk *with minor sibling(s)* ☐ Walk *with friend(s)* ☐ Walk *with a parent/adult* ☐ Bike ☐ Scooter ☐ School bus ☐ Public bus ☐ Private car ☐ Carpool
2. On a normal day, how many MINUTES does the trip take (door-to-door)?	____ minutes	____ minutes

3. What is the name of the school your child attends?	_____
4. How far is the route from home to school? (Route Distance)	____ miles
5. Is this distance close enough for your child to walk to school?	☐ Yes ☐ No
6. Does the school provide school bus service for your child?	☐ Yes ☐ No
7. If your child rides the bus, how long does it usually take to walk to the bus stop and wait for the bus?	Walking to stop: _____ minutes Waiting for bus: _____ minutes

8. How predictable is the travel time to school?	☐ Very predictable (takes the same time every day) ☐ Unpredictable (traffic/delays vary a lot)
9. How often does your child arrive at school on time?	☐ Always ☐ Usually ☐ Sometimes ☐ Rarely
10. If you drive your child to school, where do you usually go immediately afterwards?	☐ Return home ☐ Go to work ☐ Go to another school ☐ Run errands ☐ Not applicable (I do not drive my child)

The following questions are about your child's way to and from school.

11. Which of the following would your child have to cross while walking to school? (check all that apply)

☐ Highway/freeway ☐ Busy traffic roads ☐ Intersections without street signals/stop signs
☐ Vacant lot ☐ Big box retail ☐ Intersections without a crosswalk
☐ Industrial site ☐ Large parking lot ☐ Gas station ☐ Not applicable

12. Are there sidewalks along your child's way to school?

☐ Yes, on all streets ☐ Yes, on most streets ☐ Yes, on some streets ☐ Yes, on a few streets
☐ No

13. Please indicate how much you agree or disagree with the following statements about the route your child uses to travel to and from school.	**Strongly disagree**	**Somewhat disagree**	**Neither disagree nor agree**	**Somewhat agree**	**Strongly agree**
1) Sidewalks are in good condition.	1	2	3	4	5

2) Bicycle/Scooter facilities are in good condition.	1	2	3	4	5
3) The route is convenient for walking.	1	2	3	4	5
4) The route is convenient for riding a bike or scooter.	1	2	3	4	5
5) The route is well maintained and clean.	1	2	3	4	5
6) The route is well shaded by trees or buildings.	1	2	3	4	5
7) The route is quiet with little traffic noise.	1	2	3	4	5
8) The route feels safe for walking, biking, or riding a scooter	1	2	3	4	5
9) There is good visibility and lighting along the route.	1	2	3	4	5
10) Air quality along the route is good.	1	2	3	4	5
11) There are pleasant things to see along the route	1	2	3	4	5
12) School zones are well marked and enforced.	1	2	3	4	5

14. Please indicate how much you agree or disagree with the following reasons your child does NOT walk or bike to and from school.	**Strongly disagree**	**Somewhat disagree**	**Neither disagree nor agree**	**Somewhat agree**	**Strongly agree**
1) There are too many cars along the route.	1	2	3	4	5
2) Traffic speeds are too fast.	1	2	3	4	5
3) There are not enough safe crossings or crosswalks.	1	2	3	4	5
4) Sidewalks or bike lanes are missing or incomplete.	1	2	3	4	5
5) Drivers do not yield to pedestrians or cyclists.	1	2	3	4	5
6) The route is poorly lit.	1	2	3	4	5
7) My child could be hurt by a stranger.	1	2	3	4	5
8) My child could be bullied or harassed.	1	2	3	4	5
9) My child could get lost.	1	2	3	4	5
10) There are stray or aggressive animals along the route.	1	2	3	4	5
11) The school is too far from home.	1	2	3	4	5
12) The route is too hilly or difficult.	1	2	3	4	5
13) My child has too much to carry.	1	2	3	4	5
14) Air pollution or exhaust fumes are a concern.	1	2	3	4	5
15) Weather conditions make walking, biking or riding a scooter difficult.	1	2	3	4	5
16) My child is too young to walk, bike, or ride a scooter alone.	1	2	3	4	5
17) There is no adult available to accompany my child.	1	2	3	4	5
18) I do not have enough time.	1	2	3	4	5
19) Driving is faster.	1	2	3	4	5
20) Driving fits my commute to work.	1	2	3	4	5
21) My child does not want to walk or bike.	1	2	3	4	5

15. Please indicate how much you agree or disagree with each statement below.	**Strongly disagree**	**Somewhat disagree**	**Neither disagree nor agree**	**Somewhat agree**	**Strongly agree**

1) Walking to school requires too much planning ahead.	1	2	3	4	5
2) Driving my child to school fits better with my daily schedule.	1	2	3	4	5
3) I enjoy walking with my child to or from school.	1	2	3	4	5
4) I do not have enough time to walk with my child to or from school.	1	2	3	4	5
5) My child thinks walking to school is “cool”.	1	2	3	4	5
6) My child walks often as part of his/her daily routine.	1	2	3	4	5
7) My child gets too hot or sweaty when walking.	1	2	3	4	5
8) Walking is a good way for my child to get exercise.	1	2	3	4	5
9) My family and friends support walking to school.	1	2	3	4	5
10) Other children in my neighborhood walk to school.	1	2	3	4	5
11) Other parents in my neighborhood walk often.	1	2	3	4	5
12) I walk often as part of my daily routine.	1	2	3	4	5

Section 2: Physical Activity and Health

“Physical Activities” are activities that increase your child’s heart rate (above its resting rate) when he/she moves around. They can be done for fun, work, or getting around, and can be spread across the day. They can be done at different intensities or take different amounts of effort (light, moderate, or vigorous).

16. Think about a typical week during the past month. For each level of physical activity below, please estimate how many days your child participated and the average total time spent per day.

Intensity Level	How many days in a typical week?	Average total minutes per day?
Light Physical Activity (Heart rate does not increase noticeably) Examples: Walking slowly, stretching, or playing catch.	____ day	____ minutes
Moderate Physical Activity (Heart rate increases, but can still talk easily) Examples: Brisk walking, biking, playground play, or scootering.	____ day	____ minutes
Vigorous Physical Activity (Breathing hard, difficult to talk) Examples: Running, fast cycling, swimming, soccer, or playing tag.	____ day	____ minutes

17. Think about a typical day during the past week. Please estimate the total number of hours your child spent doing the following activities in a 24-hour period.

Activity Type	Average total hours per day
Sedentary / Sitting Time (Includes sitting at school, doing homework, screen time, riding in a car/bus, and hanging out)	____ hours / day
Sleeping (Includes nighttime sleep and naps)	____ hours / day

Section 3: About Your Family

18. Child Information				
Child is:	☐ Male	☐ Female	**Age:** ____	**Grade:** ____
Child’s weight:	____ pounds	**Child’s height:**	____ feet	____ inch
Ethnic group:	☐ Hispanic	☐ Non-Hispanic		
Race:	☐ White	☐ Black	☐ Asian	☐ Other

	☐ Native Hawaiian or other Pacific Islander	☐ American Indian or Alaska Native

19. Parent Information				
Your gender:	☐ Male	☐ Female	**Age:** ____	
Marital Status:	☐ Single	☐ Married	☐ Living with partner	☐ Divorced
Household Income:	☐ Under $20,000	☐ $20,000 to $39,999	☐ $40,000 to $59,999	☐ $60,000 to $79,999
	☐ $80,000 to $99,999	☐ $100,000 to $149,999	☐ $150,000 to $199,999	☐ $200,000 or more
	☐ Prefer not to answer			

20. Household Information	
How many people (including yourself) live in your household:	____ people
What are the ages of all children (under 18) in your household:	____; ____; ____; ____; ____
How many operational vehicles (cars, trucks, vans) are available to your household?	____ vehicles
How long have you lived in your current residence?	____ years

What was the primary reason you chose this neighborhood?			
☐ Housing price	☐ Close to work	☐ Convenient commute to my child's school	☐ Quality of the school
☐ Quality of the neighborhood	☐ Walkability / Easy to walk around	☐ Safety / Low crime rate	☐ Other: _____

You are finished! THANK YOU for your time and effort!